

PP → MN → FI	0.025	0.121	Rejected
GW → MN → FI	0.028	0.073	Rejected

Source: Data processed using SmartPLS 4

EC → MN → FI (Indirect effect coefficient = -0.003, $p = 0.842$): The results indicate that the mediating role of MN in the relationship between EC and FI is not statistically significant, with $p = 0.842$ (>0.05). This shows that MN does not act as a mediator between EC and FI, meaning MN is not the intermediary factor through which EC influences FI. Furthermore, EC does not significantly impact MN ($p = 0.836$) and also does not directly affect FI ($p = 0.155$). In other words, environmental concern does not lead to sustainable fashion consumption intention through a minimalist lifestyle. It is possible that EC affects FI through a different mechanism, or it is not a significant factor in this context.

LA → MN → FI (Indirect effect coefficient = 0.014, $p = 0.411$): The results show that the mediating role of MN in the relationship between PL and FI is not statistically significant, with $p = 0.411$ (>0.05). This indicates that MN does not act as a mediator between PL and FI, meaning MN is not the intermediary factor through which PL influences FI. This result is consistent with the direct effect of PL on MN being rejected, showing that PL does not have a significant influence on MN and therefore cannot indirectly impact FI through MN. This demonstrates that the sustainable label awareness has a direct impact on the intention to sustainable fashion consumption intention without going through mediating factors.

SA → MN → FI (Indirect effect coefficient = 0.050, $p = 0.008$): The results show that the relationship between SA and FI is mediated by MN, with an indirect effect coefficient of 0.050 and $p = 0.008$ (< 0.05). Therefore, MN plays a mediating role in the relationship between SA and FI, meaning that the perception of simple aesthetics not only directly influences the intention to sustainable fashion consumption intention but also does so through minimalism.

PP → MN → FI (Indirect effect coefficient = 0.025, $p = 0.121$): Although price perception has a direct influence on both minimalism ($p = 0.036$) and sustainable fashion consumption intention ($p = 0.000$), the indirect effect through MN is not statistically significant ($p = 0.121 > 0.05$). This indicates that MN does not act as a mediator in the relationship between PP and FI. In other words, price perception primarily impacts consumption intention through a direct path, not through minimalism.

GW → MN → FI (Indirect effect coefficient = 0.028, $p = 0.073$): The greenwashing perception has a positive influence on the minimalism ($p = 0.038$), but the effect of GW on consumption intention through MN is not statistically significant ($p = 0.073 > 0.05$). This shows that MN is not a mediating factor between GW and FI. Although consumers recognize greenwashing perception and tend to live more minimally, this change is not yet strong enough to translate into sustainable fashion consumption intention.

4.5. Discussion of Research Results

Discussion of Measurement Model Testing Results

The results of the scale testing indicate that the research variables in the model, including Simple Aesthetics, Greenwashing Perception, Sustainable Label Awareness, Environmental Concern, Price Perception, Minimalism, and Sustainable Fashion Consumption Intention, achieved the necessary reliability for conducting the study. Furthermore, these variables were confirmed to ensure convergent and discriminant validity, affirming the integrity and accuracy of the measurement model. Therefore, the research model is considered reliable and suitable for further in-depth analyses in subsequent stages.

Discussion of Relationship Testing Results in the Model

Based on the integrated theoretical framework of TPB and SOR proposed, the study tested the impact of factors such as Simple Aesthetics, Greenwashing Perception, Sustainable Label Awareness, Price Perception, and Environmental Concern on

Minimalism and Sustainable Fashion Consumption Intention among consumers. The analysis results clarified the mediating role of Minimalism in transforming stimulus factors into sustainable consumption behavior, while also evaluating the direct influence of certain factors, such as Sustainable Label Awareness and Environmental Concern, on Sustainable Fashion Consumption Intention. These findings not only reinforce the applicability of the model in the context of sustainable fashion consumption but also provide a scientific basis for proposing appropriate management strategies.

Hypothesis H1 proposed that Simple Aesthetics positively influences Minimalism. The obtained significance level ($\beta=0.263$, $p=0.004 < 0.05$) supports Hypothesis H1. This finding aligns with the study by Jain, Joy, and Sharma, (2024), which indicated that simple aesthetics positively affects minimalism with a coefficient of $\beta=0.553$. However, the degree of influence in this study is lower than that in Jain, Joy, and Sharma (2024). This difference may stem from the research context in Ho Chi Minh City, where cultural factors, urban lifestyles, and consumption habits may reduce the impact of minimalist aesthetics compared to studies in Western contexts. Additionally, studies by Martin-Woodhead and Waight (2023) and Wilson, and Bellezza (2024) also confirm that simple aesthetics is a core characteristic of minimalism, further supporting the results of this study. However, the lower β value may suggest that minimalist aesthetics in Ho Chi Minh City plays a supplementary rather than a decisive role in the minimalist trend.

Hypothesis H2 proposed that Greenwashing Perception positively influences the pursuit of Minimalism. The obtained significance level ($\beta=0.148$, $p=0.038 < 0.05$) supports Hypothesis H2. This finding is consistent with psychological reactance theory (Brehm, 1966), where consumers react to dishonest marketing campaigns by shifting toward a minimalist lifestyle. Compared to studies by Kasser (2017) and Wilson, and Bellezza (2024), this result reinforces the view that minimalism is a reactive consumption response to materialism and inauthentic marketing strategies. However, the relatively low influence level ($\beta=0.148$) suggests that greenwashing perception is only one of many factors

promoting minimalism in Ho Chi Minh City. This difference may be due to varying levels of sensitivity to greenwashing perception among consumers or the influence of other cultural and economic factors on consumption behavior.

Hypothesis H3 proposed that Sustainable Label Awareness positively influences Minimalism. The obtained significance level ($\beta=0.072$, $p=0.324 >0.05$) rejects Hypothesis H3, indicating that sustainable label awareness does not have a notable impact on minimalism in the situation of Ho Chi Minh City. This result contradicts the research by Yadav and Kar (2024), which demonstrated that sustainable label awareness positively influences minimalism. This difference may be explained by the level of awareness and prevalence of sustainable labels in Ho Chi Minh City, where certifications such as GOTS may not be widely recognized or valued in consumption decisions. Additionally, a lack of transparency or skepticism about the authenticity of sustainable labels in the Vietnamese market may reduce the impact of this factor on the minimalist trend.

Hypothesis H4 proposed that Environmental Concern positively influences Minimalism. The obtained significance level ($\beta=-0.016$, $p=0.836 >0.05$) rejects Hypothesis H4, indicating that environmental concern shows no notable influence on minimalism in this study. This result contradicts previous studies such as Blackburn, Leviston, and Walker (2025) and Jain, Joy, and Sharma (2024), which affirmed environmental concern as a key driver of minimalist lifestyles. This difference may stem from cultural characteristics and the level of environmental awareness in Ho Chi Minh City. Consumers here may prioritize pragmatic factors such as cost or aesthetics over environmental values when adopting a minimalist lifestyle. Additionally, the lack of sustainable product options or information about environmental impacts may diminish the role of environmental concern in shaping minimalist trends.

Hypothesis H5 proposed that Price Perception positively influences Minimalism. The obtained significance level ($\beta=0.130$, $p=0.036 <0.05$) supports Hypothesis H5. This finding aligns with studies by Wenny et al. (2021) and Blackburn, Leviston, and Walker

(2025), where consumers with high price perception often prioritize quality, sustainable products that align with the “less but better” philosophy of minimalism. However, the relatively low influence level ($\beta=0.130$) suggests that price perception is only a supplementary factor within the setting of Ho Chi Minh City, where other factors such as aesthetics or consumption habits may play a larger role.

Hypothesis H6 proposed that Environmental Concern positively influences Sustainable Consumption Intention. The obtained significance level ($\beta=0.077$, $p=0.155 > 0.05$) rejects Hypothesis H6, indicating that environmental concern does not have a significant influence on sustainable fashion consumption intention in the research context. This result contradicts previous studies such as Yue, Li, Liu, Jin, and Bao (2024) and Hartmann and Apaolaza-Ibáñez (2012), which affirmed environmental concern as a key predictor of sustainable fashion consumption intention. This difference may be due to consumers in Ho Chi Minh City not fully connecting environmental concern with sustainable fashion consumption intention, or due to barriers such as cost, product availability, or lack of information about sustainable options.

Hypothesis H7 proposed that Price Perception positively influences Sustainable Consumption Intention. The obtained significance level ($\beta=0.404$, $p=0.000 < 0.05$) supports Hypothesis H7. This finding is consistent with studies by Okur, Saricam, Iri, and Sari (2023) and Nguyen et al. (2025), where consumers with high price perception tend to purchase sustainable products if they consider the price to be reasonable relative to the benefits. The high β coefficient (0.404) indicates that price perception is a significant factor in the context of Ho Chi Minh City, where consumers tend to carefully weigh costs against the long-term value of products.

Hypothesis H8 proposed that Minimalism positively influences Sustainable Fashion Consumption Intention. The obtained significance level ($\beta=0.191$, $p=0.005 < 0.05$) supports Hypothesis H8. This result aligns with studies by Deveci & Yildiz (2025) and Laaksonen (2024), where minimalism promotes selective consumption behavior prioritizing quality

and durability, thus supporting sustainable choices. The moderate influence level ($\beta=0.191$) suggests that minimalism plays an important but not exclusive role in driving sustainable fashion consumption intentions in Ho Chi Minh City. Other factors, such as price perception or information about sustainable products, may also contribute significantly.

4.6. Summary

This chapter presented the results of survey outcomes and the corresponding analysis from a sample of young consumers in the fashion industry. Descriptive statistics presented a summary of participants' demographic information, while the scale tests ensured the reliability and discriminant validity of the research variables. The structural model analysis indicated different levels of influence in the relationships between minimalism and factors related to sustainable fashion consumption intentions. Among the eight proposed hypotheses, five were supported and three were rejected. These results provide a quantitative basis for further analyzing theoretical and practical implications, and form the basis for addressing the study's limitations and outlining future research avenues in the next chapter.

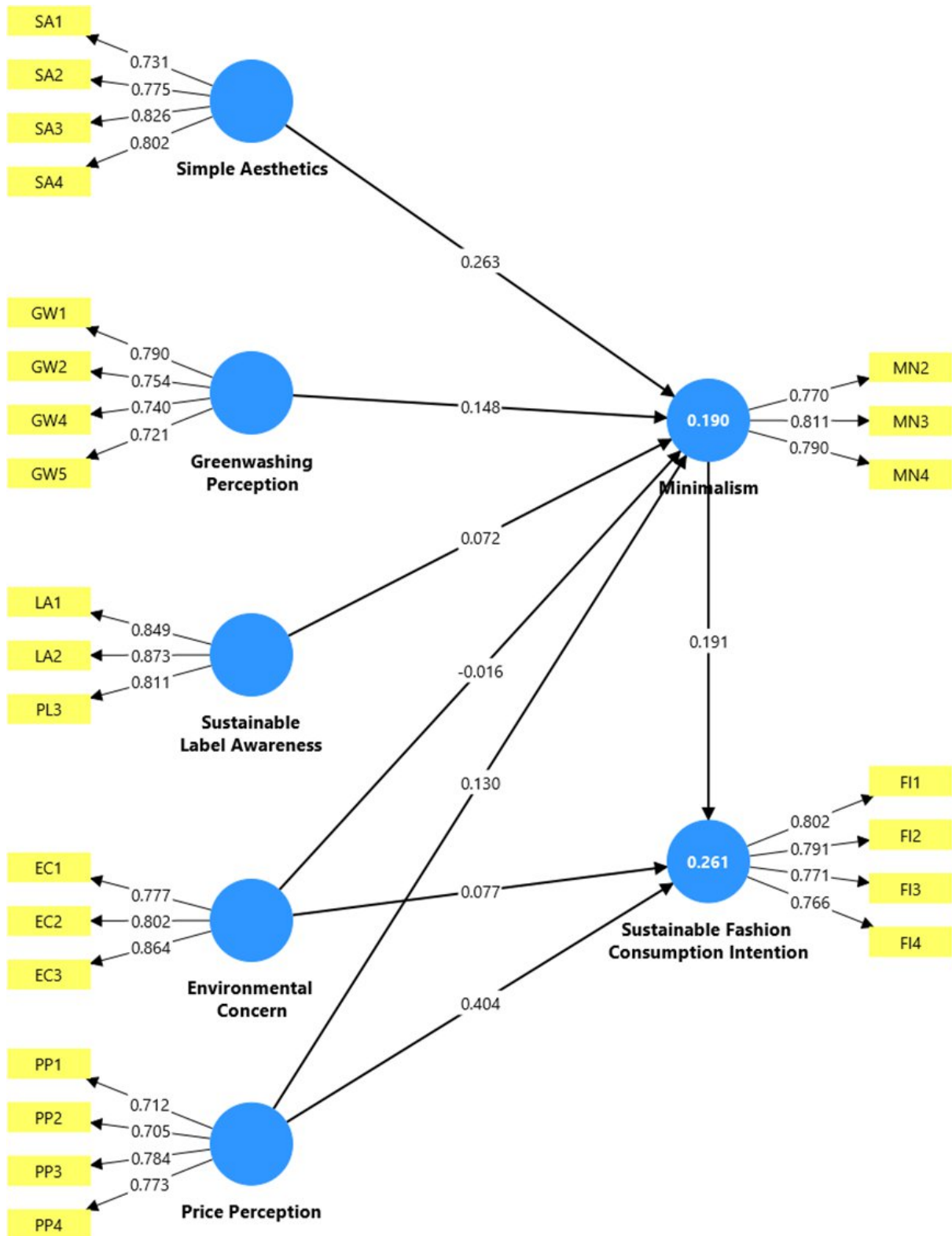


Figure 5. Results of the Research Model Analysis

Source: Data processed using SmartPLS 4

CHAPTER 5: CONCLUSION AND IMPLICATIONS

5.1. Conclusion

The main objective of the study was to examine the impact of factors including environmental concern (EC), price perception (PP), sustainable label awareness (LA), simple aesthetics (SA), greenwashing perception (GW), and minimalism (MN) on sustainable fashion consumption intention (FI). This is a topic of urgent significance in the current context, as environmental issues become increasingly severe and the trend of environmentally responsible consumption gradually becomes a standard in modern society. The inclusion of minimalism in the research model is a novel point, reflecting a changing consumption trend: a shift from mass, excessive consumption to selective consumption that focuses more on core values.

The analysis results from 354 valid responses from consumers in Ho Chi Minh City show that the scales in the model have high reliability (Cronbach's Alpha > 0.7) and ensure both convergent and discriminant validity. The analysis results indicated that price perception is the factor with a medium and the strongest impact on sustainable consumption behavior, with an effect size (f^2) of 0.205 and a standardized path coefficient of 0.404. This confirms the central role of price in consumers' sustainable product purchasing decisions. In the context of the Vietnamese market, price remains a key factor that strongly influences product choice, especially for the general customer segment. Consumers often consider economic benefits when choosing environmentally friendly products, the price difference between solid and mainstream products is one of the biggest barriers to promoting solid consumption across the board.

Furthermore, minimalism has a positive and statistically significant impact on sustainable consumption behavior ($\beta = 0.191$, $p = 0.005$), although the effect size of this factor is not yet very large ($f^2 = 0.044$). While not yet a major influence, this result reflects a shift in the consciousness of a group of Vietnamese consumers, particularly those who

are beginning to pay more attention to reducing excess consumption, prioritizing simplicity, and focusing on the quality and long-term value of products. This can be seen as a positive signal, indicating that the trend of minimalism is gradually being internalized in consumption behavior. This result suggests that minimalism is not just a personal lifestyle but also an ethical foundation and consumption philosophy capable of promoting the development of sustainable consumption in modern society.

Factors such as environmental concern (EC), greenwashing perception (GW), and sustainable label awareness (LA), although having a positive relationship, did not have a significant impact on sustainable consumption behavior. This result indicates that although consumers may be aware of environmental issues, understand sustainable labels, or recognize greenwashing, these factors are not yet strong enough to translate into actual sustainable consumption behavior. Nevertheless, the minimalist lifestyle, characterized by restraint and deep self-awareness, is playing a role in naturally and more sustainably fostering sustainability consciousness compared to conventional media impacts.

The research results have contributed to clarifying the overall picture of the key determinants of sustainable consumption behavior in Vietnam. Among them, price is a key factor, minimalism is a potential factor, while other factors have not yet had a significant impact. These findings provide valuable empirical evidence for both academic research and practical applications in business administration and policymaking.

5.2. Research implications

5.2.1. Theoretical implications

Theoretically, this study has expanded the theoretical basis of sustainable consumption behavior by adding minimalism as a new explanatory factor for responsible consumption. Unlike previous studies that primarily focused on environmental awareness or social norms, the results show that a minimalist lifestyle has a positive and direct impact on sustainable consumption behavior. The study thereby transforms minimalism from a

cultural phenomenon into a measurable social variable, clarifying the role of life values and personal philosophy in forming green consumer intentions, and filling a theoretical gap in current consumer behavior models.

The study has made a significant contribution to expanding and deepening the theoretical framework of green consumption behavior by integrating two foundational models: the Theory of Planned Behavior (TPB) and the Stimulus-Organism-Response (SOR). This combination allows for a more comprehensive explanation of the process of forming sustainable consumption intention, where external stimuli (such as perceptions of price, sustainable labels, or personal values) affect the internal psychological state (organism), manifested through a minimalist lifestyle, which in turn leads to a behavioral response (intention to consume sustainable fashion). This approach helps overcome the limitations of traditional models, which mainly focus on the linear relationship between cognition and behavior without deeply considering the mediating psychological factors and life values of consumers.

The successful testing of the mediating role of minimalism is a significant theoretical contribution, as it confirms the indirect impact mechanism between external stimuli and sustainable consumption behavior. The study has elevated minimalism from a social trend to a psychological-behavioral construct that can be measured and empirically tested, expanding the theoretical framework of green consumption behavior. In doing so, this work positions minimalism as a new structural variable, creating a foundation for future research on lifestyle and sustainable consumption. The theoretical contribution of this study lies not only in clarifying the impact of minimalism on sustainable consumption but also in shaping a new mindset for future research, where humans are seen as the center of sustainable development, and consumption behavior is viewed as a concrete expression of life values, ethical philosophy, along with a sense of social responsibility and environmental protection.

5.2.2. Practical implications

From a practical standpoint, this study offers important implications for promoting sustainable consumption behavior in the context of Vietnam's gradual transition to a green economy and sustainable development. Currently, the country faces many alarming environmental problems such as air pollution, increasing plastic waste, over-exploitation of resources, and immense pressure on urban waste treatment systems. In this context, fostering and expanding sustainable consumption behavior is particularly crucial for achieving national sustainable development goals.

The research results have shown that the price factor plays a decisive role in consumers' sustainable consumption behavior. This is also the main barrier preventing many people from choosing environmentally friendly products. The reality in Vietnam shows that the majority of consumers are still price-sensitive, especially those in the middle and low-income groups. The study also shows that awareness of sustainable labels and greenwashing currently does not have a significant impact on actual behavior. This reflects limitations in the certification and control systems for greenwashing in Vietnam. When consumers do not truly trust labels, information about green products is easily overlooked, leading to a large gap between awareness and behavior.

Particularly when related to the reality in TP. HCM, the research findings are even more highly meaningful. The city is the largest economic and commercial center in the country, with a dense population, numerous production and service activities, and it is also the locality facing the greatest environmental pressure. Concurrently, the rapid growth of the middle class, with good purchasing power and high access to information, has created favorable conditions for promoting sustainable consumption models.

Clarifying the relationship between minimalism and sustainable consumption behavior not only contributes to expanding the understanding of modern consumer behavior but also provides concrete suggestions for businesses, government agencies, social organizations, and consumers themselves in promoting a responsible and

environmentally friendly consumption model. It can be seen that the minimalist lifestyle is increasingly influencing consumption behavior, opening up opportunities for product development and marketing strategies based on the "less but better" value proposition. Businesses can focus on creating products with simple designs, high durability, and environmental friendliness, and communicate transparently about their sustainability.

Regulatory agencies can use these results to develop community communication programs, integrate education on life values and responsible consumption into sustainable development policies, encourage conscious consumption behavior, strengthen trust in sustainable certifications, and issue specific support policies for green businesses. This is an important step in shaping the market towards greater sustainability while reducing pressure on the urban environment. For consumers, adopting a minimalist lifestyle not only helps reduce spending and material stress but also encourages selective consumption, reduces waste, and leads to a more balanced and meaningful life. Thus, the practical significance of the study is demonstrated by translating the philosophy of minimalism into concrete actions, contributing to promoting a shift in consumer awareness and behavior towards being more responsible, humane, and sustainable.

In summary, the research results not only have theoretical value but also create a solid practical basis for businesses, managers, and consumers to participate in the process of building a sustainable consumption ecosystem. In large cities like TP. HCM, which possess all the necessary economic, social, and living standard conditions, these implications are highly applicable and can act as an important lever to promote the transition to green and responsible consumption.

5.3. Limitations and Future Research

Although this study has made significant contributions to clarifying the role of minimalism in shaping sustainable fashion consumption intentions TP. HCM, several limitations remain. These limitations highlight opportunities for future research to enhance the comprehensiveness and reliability of the findings.

First, the sample size of this study may not be large enough to fully represent the diversity of consumers in TP. HCM. Although a probability random sampling method was employed, the use of an online survey via Google Forms may have introduced bias, as certain demographic groups who do not use the internet or are unfamiliar with online surveys might have been excluded. Future studies should increase the sample size and adopt more diverse data collection methods, such as in-person interviews or on-site surveys, to improve representativeness and minimize sampling bias.

Second, the observed variables used in this study, including perceptions of greenwashing, awareness of sustainable labeling, and environmental concern, were constructed on solid theoretical foundations but may not fully capture all factors influencing minimalism and sustainable fashion consumption intentions in TP. HCM. Factors such as urban cultural influence, individual psychological motivations, or specific consumption trends of the city were not thoroughly examined. Future research should examine these additional elements and consider the contribution of social media or environmental education in shaping green consumption behavior in local contexts.

Third, while this study acknowledged the existence of the awareness and action gap, the detailed mechanisms underlying this gap were not deeply analyzed. Factors hindering the translation of awareness into actual behavior, such as cost, consumption habits, or lack of information about sustainable products, were not examined in depth. Future studies should employ qualitative methods or advanced analytical models to identify and address these barriers, thereby proposing practical solutions to bridge this gap in TP. HCM.

Fourth, the data were gathered over a short period from September 25, 2025 to October 9, 2025, which may not capture temporal variations in consumer perceptions and behaviors in TP. HCM. Sustainable consumption trends and minimalism can be influenced by economic and social fluctuations within the city. Therefore, future studies should apply longitudinal research designs to monitor behavioral changes over time,

providing insights into the durability and long-term impacts of these trends in Ho Chi Minh City.

Finally, to enhance practical applicability, future research should focus on proposing specific strategies for businesses and local authorities in Ho Chi Minh City. These may include community education programs on sustainable consumption, incentives for green fashion enterprises, or communication campaigns aimed at raising awareness about minimalist lifestyles and environmental impacts. Such directions would not only address current limitations but also contribute to fostering a more sustainable fashion ecosystem in Ho Chi Minh City.

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